

port for additional music players in the future since limiting this feature to just one music player seems wasteful.

PRIVACY AND SECURITY

ColorOS 13 has integrated some of the underlying privacy capabilities of Android 13 such as deleting clipboard history after a designated period of time. There's also the Nearby Wi-Fi feature that allows users to use Wi-Fi without revealing any specific location information.

Aside from Android 13 privacy and security features, Oppo has integrated some additional ones from their side as well. Firstly, there's the Auto Screenshot Pixelate feature. If you've ever wanted to take a screenshot of a conversation and share it, you may find this feature very useful. ColorOS 13 can automatically pixelate avatars and names in screenshots of chats. It uses AI algorithms to intelligently predict which part of the chat needs to be blurred out.

When we used this feature, it seemed buggy since there were many instances when the phone just gave out an Auto Pixelate error. Nevertheless, at times, it did work as advertised. Hopefully, the feature gets more stable and reliable over time since it is something that's pretty useful. This feature is available in Oppo's Messages app, WhatsApp, and Facebook Messenger for now.

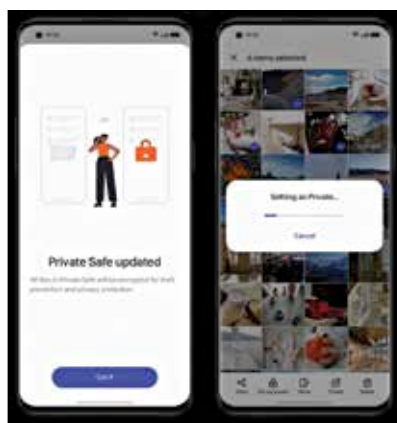
Another privacy feature added by Oppo is the Private Safe. This is a folder that is encrypted using the AES algorithm that stores the files in a private directory.

MISCELLANEOUS

Oppo's cross-device collaboration feature dubbed 'Multi-screen connect' has become more powerful in ColorOS 13. Multi-screen connect was first limited to Windows PCs, but it can now be used on an Oppo tablet too such as the Oppo

Pad Air. The feature allows you to seamlessly transfer files between your phone and connected device. ColorOS 13 has added support for more file types. You can also directly edit files stored on your phone from your PC or Oppo tablet, which is very useful.

The newest addition to this feature in ColorOS 13 is the ability to get all of your notifications synced and to be able to fully control your phone remotely. At times, we found that clipboard sync was a bit buggy, where the clipboard data did not show up on the connected device, but most times, the feature worked quite well.



Private Safe

ColorOS 13 also sports a feature called 'Meeting Assistant'. It includes features such as simplified or less distracting banner notifications during online meetings, note-taking in a pop-up window, and background network optimisation for video calls.

Aside from these, Oppo also claims that its new software is more battery efficient. The company also states that more apps can remain active in the background due to improved memory management. We haven't tested these claims thoroughly yet,

but when we do, we'll surely update this article with our findings.

COLOROS ROLLOUT SCHEDULE

Due to Oppo's close ties with Google on the Android OS front, Oppo users usually benefit from earlier and timely updates for their devices. Oppo has shared a tentative ColorOS 13 rollout schedule that is subject to change, so take it with a grain of salt. Oppo notes that all of these upcoming ColorOS 13 updates will be based on Android 13. Here's the tentative rollout schedule:

- From September 2022: Reno8 Pro 5G
- From October 2022: Reno8 5G, Reno7 Pro 5G, Reno7 5G, Reno6 5G, F21 Pro, K10 5G, A76
- From November 2022: Reno6 Pro 5G, Reno6 Pro 5G Diwali Edition, Reno5 Pro 5G, F21 Pro 5G, F19 Pro+, K10, A96
- From December 2022: Find X2, A74 5G
- From H1 2023: Oppo Pad Air, F19 Pro, F19, F19s, A77, A57, A55, A53s 5G

VERDICT

ColorOS 13 continues Oppo's trend of improving their operating system year after year, bringing it closer than ever to a Stock Android minimalist look and feel. While there are still some bugs and tons of bloatware, ColorOS 13 feels more fluid and responsive than its previous renditions. The visual flair and tweaks are quite elegant yet muted. They don't ever feel too garish. Additionally, features such as multi-screen connect with notifications sync, auto pixelate, AOD improvements, and more are not just gimmicks. These are features that we actually found to be quite nifty in real life. Overall, ColorOS 13 is the best iteration of Oppo's operating system yet. **d**

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